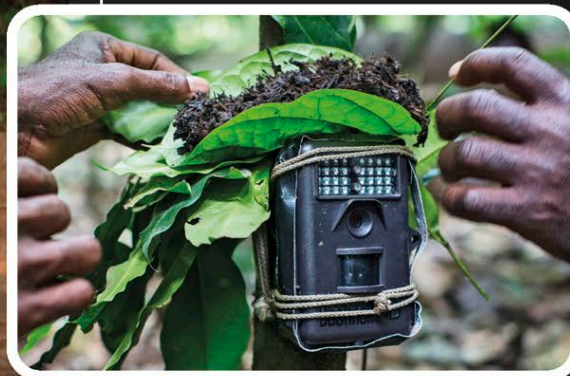


CONSERVATION TOOL

CAMERA TRAPS

It can be difficult to observe wild animals up close, so scientists often use camera traps to monitor wildlife remotely. Any animal roaming past a camera trap triggers the device's sensors through either their body heat or movement, which causes the camera to take a picture. These cameras allow conservationists to track wild animals, monitor their numbers, determine their locations, and even study their behaviors. The data collected can be useful in protecting endangered animals.



PLACING TRAPS

Camera traps, such as this one being set up in a national park in the Republic of Congo, must be placed in spots where animals are likely to visit. Scientists have to carefully hide the cameras to protect them from being destroyed by animals or even stolen by people.

Tigers are one of the most endangered animals on Earth, with less than 4,000 left in the wild.

CONSERVATION

Despite the efforts of people trying to protect and conserve them, many animal species are in decline due to habitat loss, pollution, poaching, and climate change. The International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN) Red List is a tool to examine how likely a species is to go extinct, which helps scientists decide where to focus their conservation efforts. The list has seven categories—from species of least concern to those that are already extinct. Tigers are more threatened than some of their other big cat relatives, but they still have small wild populations.



JAGUAR:
NEAR THREATENED



SUMATRAN TIGER:
CRITICALLY
ENDANGERED



THYLACINE:
EXTINCT